Universal Declaration of Human Rights
Preamble Whereas recognition of the
inherent dignity and of the equal and
inalienable rights of all members of the
human family is the foundation of
freedom, justice and peace in the world,
Whereas disregard and contempt for
human rights have resulted in
barbarous acts which have outraged
the conscience of mankind, and the
advent of a world in which human beings shall enjoy
freedom of speech and belief and freedom from fear and want has been proclaimed as the highest aspiration of the common people, Whereas it is essential, if man is not to be compelled to
have recourse, as a last resort, to rebellion against tyranny and oppression, that human rights should be protected by the rule of law, Whereas it is essential to promote the development of friendly relations
between nations, Whereas the peoples of the United Nations have in the Charter reaffirmed their faith in fundamental human rights, in the dignity and worth of the human person and in the equal rights of men and women and have
determined to promote social progress and better standards of life in larger freedom, Whereas Member States have pledged themselves to achieve, in cooperation with the United Nations, the promotion of universal respect for and
observance of human rights and fundamental freedoms, Whereas a common understanding of these rights and freedoms is of the greatest importance for the full realization of this pledge, Now, therefore, The General Assembly,
Proclaims this Universal Declaration of Human Rights as a common standard of achievement for all peoples and all nations, to the end that every individual and every organ of society, keeping this Declaration constantly in mind,
shall strive by teaching and education to promote respect for these rights and freedoms and by progressive measures, national and international, to secure their universal and effective recognition and observance, both among the peoples of
Member States themselves and among the peoples of territories under their jurisdiction. ### Article 1 All human beings are born free and equal in dignity and rights. They are endowed with reason and conscience and should act
towards one another in a spirit of brotherhood. ### Article 2 Everyone is entitled to all the rights and freedoms set forth in this Declaration, without distinction of any kind, such as race, colour, sex, language, religion,
political or other opinion, national or social origin, property, birth or other status. Furthermore, no distinction shall be made on the basis of the political, urisdictional or international status
of the country or territory to which a person belongs, whether it be independent, trust, non-self-governing or under any other limitation of sovereignty. ### Article 3 Everyone has the right to life, liberty
and the security of person. ### Article 4 No one shall be held in slavery or servitude; slavery and the slave trade shall be prohibited in all their forms. ### Article 5 No one shall be subjected to torture or to cruel, inhuman
or degrading treatment or punishment. ### Article 6 Everyone has the right to recognition everywhere as a person before the law. ### Article 7 All are equal before the law and are
entitled without any discrimination to equal protection of the law. All are entitled to equal protection against any discrimination in violation of this Declaration and against any incitement to such
discrimination. ### Article 8 Everyone has the right to an effective remedy by the competent national tribunals for acts violating the fundamental rights granted him by the constitution or by law. ### Article 9
No one shall be subjected to arbitrary arrest, detention or exile. ### Article 10 Everyone is entitled in full equality to a fair and public hearing by an independent and impartial tribunal, in the determination of his
rights and obligations and of any criminal charge against him. ### Article 11 1. Everyone charged with a penal offence has the right to be presumed innocent until proved guilty according to law in a public trial at which
he has had all the guarantees necessary for his defence. 2. No one shall be held guilty of any penal offence on account of any act or omission which did not constitute a penal offence, under national or
international law, at the time when it was committed. Nor shall a heavier penalty be imposed than the one that was applicable at the time the penal offence was committed. ### Article 12 No one
shall be subjected to arbitrary interference with his privacy, family, home or correspondence, nor to attacks upon his honour and reputation. Everyone has the right to the protection of the law against such

interference or attacks. ### Article 13 1. Everyone has the right
o freedom of movement and residence within the borders of each
State. 2. Everyone has the right to leave any country, including his own, and to
return to his country. ### Article 14 1. Everyone has the right to seek and to
enjoy in other countries asylum from persecution. 2. This right may not be
nvoked in the case of prosecutions genuinely arising from non-political crimes
or from acts contrary to the purposes and principles of the United Nations. ### Article 15 1.
Everyone has the right to a nationality. 2. No one shall be arbitrarily deprived of his nationality nor
denied the right to change his nationality. ### Article 16 1. Men and women of full age, without any
imitation due to race, nationality or religion, have the right to marry and to found a family. They
are entitled to equal rights as to marriage, during marriage and at its dissolution. 2.
Marriage shall be entered into only with the free and full consent of the intending spouses. 3. The family is the natural and fundamental group unit of society and is entitled to
protection by society and the State. ### Article 17 1. Everyone has the right to own property alone as well as in association with others. 2. No one shall be arbitrarily deprived of
his property. ### Article 18 Everyone has the right to freedom of thought, conscience and religion; this right includes freedom to change his religion or belief, and freedom, either alone or in community with
others and in public or private, to manifest his religion or belief in teaching, practice, worship and observance. ### Article 19 Everyone has the right to freedom of opinion and expression; this right includes freedom
o hold opinions without interference and to seek, receive and impart information and ideas through any media and regardless of frontiers. ### Article 20 1. Everyone has the right to freedom of peaceful assembly and
association. 2. No one may be compelled to belong to an association. ### Article 21 1. Everyone has the right to take part in the government of his country, directly or through freely chosen representatives. 2.
Everyone has the right of equal access to public service in his country. 3. The will of the people shall be the basis of the authority of government; this will shall be expressed in periodic and genuine elections which
shall be by universal and equal suffrage and shall be held by secret vote or by equivalent free voting procedures. ### Article 22 Everyone, as a member of society, has the right to social security and is entitled
o realization, through national effort and international co-operation and in accordance with the organization and resources of each State, of the economic, social and cultural rights
ndispensable for his dignity and the free development of his personality. ### Article 23 1. Everyone has the right to work, to free choice of employment, to just and favourable
conditions of work and to protection against unemployment. 2. Everyone, without any discrimination, has the right to equal pay for equal work. 3. Everyone who works has the
right to just and favourable remuneration ensuring for himself and his family an existence worthy of human dignity, and supplemented, if necessary, by other means of social
protection. 4. Everyone has the right to form and to join trade unions for the protection of his interests. ### Article 24 Everyone has the right to rest and leisure, including
reasonable limitation of working hours and periodic holidays with pay. ### Article 25 1. Everyone has the right to a standard of living adequate for he health and well-being of himself and of his family, including
ood, clothing, housing and medical care and necessary social services, and the right to security in the event of unemployment, sickness, disability, widowhood, old age or other lack of
ivelihood in circumstances beyond his control. 2. Motherhood and childhood are entitled to special care and assistance. All children, whether born in or out of wedlock, shall enjoy the same
social protection. ### Article 26 1. Everyone has the right to education. Education shall be free, at least in the elementary and fundamental stages. Elementary education shall be
compulsory. Technical and professional education shall be made generally available and higher education shall be equally accessible to all on the basis of merit. 2. Education
shall be directed to the full development of the human personality and to the strengthening of respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms. It shall promote understanding,
tolerance and friendship among all nations, racial or religious groups, and shall further the activities of the United Nations for the maintenance of peace. 3. Parents have a prior right to choose the
kind of education
that shall be given to their
children. ### Article 27 1. Everyone has
the right freely to participate in the
cultural life of the community, to enjoy
the arts and to share in scientific
advancement and its benefits. 2.
Everyone has the right to the
protection of the moral

and mat
int ts res fro any sc lite or artistic pro ction of which he is the aut ##
Art 28 Eve is ent to a soc and int atio orde in wh the rig ts an freed set for
in this Declara n can be fully realize . ### Art 29 1. Every has du s to the comm nity in which alone the ree and full develo men of his per on is possibl . 2. In the ex ise of his rights and
fre ms everyone sha be subject only to suc limitatio s as are determi ed by law solely for the purpose of securing due rec ition and res ct for the rights and fre of oth s and of mee ing the just requirement of
mo y, pub order and the general welfare in a dem tic society. 3. Th se rights an freedom ma in no case be exe d contrary to the pur and pri s of the Un Na ns. ### Article 30
Not g n this Decl atio ma be inte pre d as im ying for any Sta e, gro p or pe n any righ to eng e in an act or to perform any act aimed at the de tion of any of the rights
and ree ms set fort herein.